BOLUTIFE AWAKAN

Brand designer, design leader and founder

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Lagos, Nigeria and London, UK

Profile

I started out as a self-taught graphic designer. Over a decade later, I've built brands, led creative teams, and started ventures of my own. I still care deeply about the craft. I'm just as interested in the people, decisions, and systems that make the work matter.

As much as I'm a visionary, I'm also an operator. I like to break things down to their fundamentals and build them back up, and to get results in execution as much as in strategy.

Experience

Group Design Lead — 2026 - Now
Risevest, Nigeria

Creative Director — 2021 - 2023
Capex Funds

Senior Brand Designer — 2024 - 2025
Interswitch Group, Nigeria

Brand & Creatives Manager — 2022 - 2024
Traction Apps, Nigeria

Senior Brand & Marketing Designer — 2021 - 2022
Terragon Group, Nigeria

Brand Designer — 2020
MSports Limited, West Africa

Creative Designer — 2016 - 2020
Showgear Limited, Nigeria

Selected highlights

Led the rebrand of Traction Apps, supporting a $6M raise — 2025

Recognized among the top 0.8% of freelance designers worldwide (Team&Tonic) — 2023

Created brand systems still in use years later at companies like Terragon and Interswitch — 2023

Ventures

Design Lever Inc., founder
A design leadership firm helping African businesses build stronger design functions while creating opportunities for designers to grow.

Lilac Africa, founder
Creating better access to education, mentorship, and career opportunities for women in design and technology.

Education

Executive MBA for Design Leaders 2025
Future London Academy

International MBA 2024
Rome Business School

Masters of Business Administration 2024
Valencia de Universidad

Design Management Fellow 2023
Coho

Recognition

Exponential Design Leader 2026

Top 0.8% of Freelance Designers Worldwide 2025
Team & Tonic

Cloudde Tech Honourary Award 2024
Cloudde

Brand Designer of the Year 2023
No Code Tech Summit

Practice

Branding. I develop brand positioning, identities, and visual systems that connect business direction with how people recognise and experience a brand.

Creative direction. I shape creative direction across campaigns, launches, and brand experiences, guiding ideas from concept through execution.

Design leadership. I lead design teams and build the people, processes, and standards that help businesses get more value from design.

Speaking

Branding, Design leadership, Business of design, Creative careers, Women in Technology.

Rethinking Design Leadership: What emerging markets can teach the world

Beyond Visibility: Building a Personal Brand That Creates Opportunities, WIMD Summit 2026